Project Completion Report

Project Title: School Supply Distribution
Organization: Apoti Development Association (ADA)
Reference Number: ADA/2022/001
Project Location: Buea, South-West Region, Cameroon
Implementation Period: February 1–28, 2022
Total Beneficiaries: 20 orphaned children
Total Budget: $500 USD (300,000 CFA)
Report Date: March 10, 2022

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1. Executive Summary

On February 15, 2022, the Apoti Development Association (ADA) conducted its first school-based distribution event at a rural primary school in Buea, South-West Region, Cameroon. A team of 8 volunteers — more than double the founding team of 3 — distributed complete supply kits to 20 orphaned children enrolled at the school. Each child received a colorful plastic bucket filled with plates, cups, and eating utensils, along with a pink school bag. The distribution was accompanied by an interactive engagement session featuring songs, encouragement, and group activities designed to make the children feel celebrated and valued.

This project marked several organizational firsts for ADA: the first intervention targeting children, the first partnership with a school institution, the first large-scale distribution event (as opposed to individual home visits), and the first project coordinated by an expanded volunteer team. The event was completed within budget — spending approximately 280,000 CFA ($467 USD) of the 300,000 CFA ($500 USD) approved — and achieved all planned objectives. The success of this event validated ADA's capacity to scale beyond individual home visits and established a replicable model for future school-based interventions.

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2. Project Background

2.1 Context

Orphaned children in Cameroon's South-West Region face a convergence of vulnerabilities. The ongoing Anglophone crisis has disrupted education systems, displaced families, and destroyed livelihoods. Children who have lost parents — whether to conflict, disease, or other causes — often find themselves in the care of elderly grandparents or overburdened relatives who cannot afford basic school supplies. In rural schools around Buea, it is common to find children attending class without bags, eating from shared containers during feeding programmes, and lacking the basic materials that support both learning and daily life.

The school selected for this intervention is a rural primary school serving a community with a high proportion of vulnerable households. Teachers reported that many enrolled children were orphans living with extended family, and that the absence of basic supplies was a visible marker of their vulnerability — contributing to stigma and reduced participation in school activities.

2.2 Organizational Context

By February 2022, ADA had completed one project (ADA/2021/001 — First Widow Home Visits) and was actively growing its volunteer base. The founding team of 3 had attracted 5 additional volunteers through word-of-mouth and church community connections, bringing the active team to 8. This growth reflected increasing community awareness of ADA's mission and a desire among young people in Buea to contribute to meaningful social action.

The decision to focus on orphaned children was informed by findings from the 2021 widow visits, where the team encountered elderly widows caring for grandchildren who lacked basic necessities. The School Supply Distribution project represented a deliberate expansion of ADA's target population from elderly widows to include orphaned children — the second pillar of the organization's stated mission.

2.3 Rationale

The project was motivated by:

- Direct observations during 2021 widow visits of orphaned children lacking basic supplies
- Reports from community members and church networks about orphaned children in rural schools
- ADA's organizational mandate to serve orphans as a core beneficiary group
- The opportunity to test a new delivery model (school-based event) beyond individual home visits
- The availability of an expanded volunteer team capable of executing a larger-scale intervention
- A desire to create a joyful, community-building experience for vulnerable children

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3. Objectives vs Achievements

#	Planned Objective	Achievement	Status
1	Distribute complete supply kits to 20 orphaned children	20 children received full kits (bucket, utensils, school bag)	✅ Achieved
2	Conduct interactive engagement session with children	Songs, games, and encouragement session held with all 20 children	✅ Achieved
3	Establish partnership with a primary school	School administration actively collaborated on identification and hosting	✅ Achieved
4	Coordinate 8 volunteers in a school-based event	All 8 volunteers participated with defined roles	✅ Achieved
5	Document event for future programming and reporting	Photos, beneficiary records, and event report completed	✅ Achieved

Overall Achievement Rate: 100%

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4. Activities Implemented

4.1 Preparation Phase (February 1–5)

The project coordinator engaged the school administration to explain ADA's mission and propose the distribution event. The school head teacher was receptive and enthusiastic, having observed the material needs of orphaned students firsthand. Together with class teachers, the team identified 20 children meeting the selection criteria: orphaned, enrolled, and lacking basic supplies. Teachers provided valuable context about each child's home situation, confirming eligibility.

Simultaneously, the logistics lead began market research for procurement, visiting Buea Main Market and surrounding shops to compare prices for plastic buckets, eating utensils, and school bags. Wholesale pricing was identified for several items, which would ultimately contribute to the project coming in under budget.

4.2 Procurement & Kit Assembly (February 6–10)

The logistics team purchased all items over two market visits:

- **20 colorful plastic buckets** — Selected in bright colors (red, blue, yellow, green) to appeal to children and serve as both storage containers and carrying vessels
- **20 sets of plates, cups, and utensils** — Durable melamine plates, plastic cups, and stainless steel spoons and forks suitable for children
- **20 pink school bags** — Lightweight, child-sized bags with multiple compartments, selected in pink as a unifying color for the cohort

Kit assembly was conducted at a volunteer's home, with team members filling each bucket with the plate, cup, and utensil set, then pairing each bucket with a school bag. The assembly process doubled as a team-building exercise, with volunteers working together while discussing event logistics.

Several items were purchased at wholesale prices below the budgeted unit cost, resulting in savings that were noted for the financial report.

4.3 Volunteer Briefing & Logistics (February 11–14)

A volunteer briefing session was held on February 13 to assign roles, review the event programme, and address logistics. The 8 volunteers were organized into functional teams:

- **Coordination team** (2 persons): Overall event flow, school liaison, timing
- **Distribution team** (3 persons): Kit handover to children, ensuring completeness
- **Engagement team** (2 persons): Interactive session facilitation, songs, games
- **Documentation team** (1 person): Photography, beneficiary forms, event records

Vehicle hire was confirmed for February 15 to transport the 20 assembled kits from the assembly point to the school. The event programme was finalized: arrival and setup, interactive engagement session, distribution of kits, refreshments, and closing.

4.4 Distribution Event (February 15, 2022)

The team arrived at the school by 9:00 AM with all 20 supply kits loaded in the hired vehicle. Setup took approximately 30 minutes, with kits arranged in a colorful display that immediately attracted the attention and excitement of the children.

Interactive Engagement Session (9:30–10:15 AM)

The engagement team led the 20 beneficiary children through a programme of:

- Welcome songs and introductions
- Group games designed to build confidence and teamwork
- Words of encouragement about the value of education and their worth as individuals
- A brief explanation of ADA's mission and why the team was there — framed as community members who care about them

The children were initially shy but quickly warmed to the activities. Several teachers observed the session and commented on the positive energy and the children's visible excitement.

Distribution (10:15–11:00 AM)

Each child was called by name to receive their kit. The distribution team ensured every child received:

- One colorful plastic bucket containing a plate, cup, spoon, and fork

- One pink school bag

Children's reactions ranged from quiet smiles to open expressions of joy. Several children immediately put on their new school bags and carried their buckets with visible pride. The uniformity of the kits — everyone receiving the same items — was noted by teachers as important for avoiding comparison or jealousy among the children.

Refreshments & Closing (11:00–11:30 AM)

Following the distribution, children were provided with drinks and biscuits. The team used this informal time to interact individually with children, take photographs (with consent), and complete beneficiary acknowledgment forms. The event concluded with a group photo and words of encouragement from the project coordinator.

4.5 Post-Event Activities (February 16–28)

Following the event, the team conducted a debrief session to capture observations and lessons learned. The documentation lead compiled photographs, organized beneficiary records, and drafted the event report. The logistics lead reconciled all expenditures against the budget and collected outstanding receipts. A brief follow-up conversation with the school head teacher confirmed satisfaction with the event and expressed interest in future collaboration.

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5. Beneficiary Profiles

5.1 Demographic Summary

Characteristic	Detail
Total beneficiaries	20 children
Gender	12 girls, 8 boys
Age range	5–12 years
Class levels	Class 1 through Class 6
Orphan status	14 single orphans (one parent deceased), 6 double orphans (both parents deceased)
Primary caregivers	Grandparents (8), aunts/uncles (7), older siblings (3), community members (2)

5.2 Common Characteristics

All 20 beneficiary children shared the following characteristics:

- Enrolled at the partner primary school but attending without adequate supplies
- Living in households with limited financial resources
- Identified by teachers as among the most materially deprived students in their classes
- Previously lacking a school bag (carrying materials by hand or in plastic bags)
- Sharing eating utensils with other household members or using improvised containers

5.3 Notable Observations

- Several children had never owned a school bag before and were visibly emotional upon receiving one
- The plastic buckets were immediately recognized as valuable household items — children understood they could use them for water carrying, storage, and washing
- Teachers reported that the 6 double orphans were among the most vulnerable children in the school, with some walking significant distances from caregivers' homes
- The youngest beneficiaries (age 5–6) required assistance from older children to carry their complete kits home

Note: Individual names and identifying details are withheld to protect the privacy and dignity of the children.

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6. Outcomes & Impact

6.1 Immediate Outcomes

- **Material provision:** All 20 children received complete supply kits addressing both school needs (bag) and household needs (bucket, eating utensils)
- **Dignity and belonging:** The celebratory nature of the event — with songs, games, and individual recognition — communicated to each child that they are valued members of their community
- **Practical utility:** Each kit item serves ongoing daily needs: bags for school materials, buckets for water/storage, utensils for meals
- **Peer equity:** Uniform kits eliminated visible markers of deprivation among the 20 children within the school community

6.2 Organizational Outcomes

- **Operational scaling demonstrated:** ADA successfully coordinated 8 volunteers in a structured event — proving capacity beyond the 3-person home visit model
- **New delivery model validated:** School-based distribution proved efficient for reaching multiple beneficiaries simultaneously while maintaining a personal, dignified approach
- **Institutional partnership established:** The school administration expressed strong interest in ongoing collaboration, creating a platform for future interventions
- **Team cohesion strengthened:** The shared experience of planning and executing the event bonded the expanded volunteer team and clarified working relationships
- **Volunteer recruitment validated:** Growth from 3 to 8 volunteers demonstrated ADA's ability to attract and retain committed team members

6.3 Longer-Term Impact

- The school partnership created a channel for identifying future beneficiaries and monitoring children's progress over time
- The event established ADA's reputation in the school community, leading to subsequent referrals and requests for support
- The experience of coordinating a larger team informed ADA's organizational development and volunteer management practices
- Documentation from the event provided compelling materials for future fundraising and donor engagement
- The model of combining material distribution with interactive engagement became ADA's standard approach for child-focused events

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7. Challenges & Lessons Learned

7.1 Challenges Encountered

Challenge	Description	How It Was Addressed
Selecting only 20 children	The school had more than 20 orphaned or vulnerable children; limiting to 20 was difficult	Applied strict criteria with teacher input; committed to returning for additional children in future projects
Transport logistics	Fitting 20 assembled kits (buckets + bags) into a single hired vehicle required careful planning	Conducted a test load the day before; rearranged kit packaging to maximize space
Shy children during engagement	Some younger children were initially overwhelmed by the attention and unfamiliar adults	Engagement team used gentle, age-appropriate activities; paired shy children with more confident peers
Coordination of 8 volunteers	First time managing a team this size; required clearer communication than the 3-person model	Pre-event briefing with written role assignments; designated team leads for each function
Time management	Event ran approximately 20 minutes longer than planned due to individual photo documentation	Adjusted programme in real-time; prioritized distribution completion over strict schedule adherence
Budget constraints on kit contents	Would have liked to include additional items (notebooks, pencils) but budget was limited	Focused on high-impact, durable items; noted additional items as opportunity for future projects

7.2 Lessons Learned

1. **School partnerships multiply impact.** Working through an institution enabled efficient beneficiary identification, provided a venue, and created a framework for ongoing engagement. Future projects should prioritize institutional partnerships.

2. **Children need celebration, not just provision.** The interactive engagement session was as important as the material distribution. Children responded to being seen, named, and celebrated. Future events should always include a relational component.

3. **Uniform kits prevent stigma.** Giving every child identical items eliminated comparison and ensured no child felt they received "less." This principle should be maintained in all future distributions.

4. **Larger teams require structure.** The jump from 3 to 8 volunteers necessitated written role assignments, a pre-event briefing, and designated team leads. ADA should formalize volunteer coordination processes as the team continues to grow.

5. **Wholesale procurement saves money.** Buying items in bulk (20 units) enabled wholesale pricing that brought the project under budget. Future projects should always seek bulk discounts and compare multiple vendors.

6. **Documentation requires a dedicated person.** Assigning one volunteer exclusively to photography and forms ensured comprehensive documentation without disrupting the event flow. This role should be standard for all future events.

7. **Start with what you can do.** The team acknowledged that 20 kits could not solve all the children's problems, but the focused intervention made a tangible difference. Perfectionism should not

prevent action.

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8. Photos & Documentation

Photographs were taken during the distribution event with the consent of school administration and in accordance with child protection principles. These images document:

- Assembled supply kits (buckets filled with utensils, paired with school bags) before distribution
- The colorful display of kits at the school venue
- Interactive engagement session (songs, games, group activities)
- Individual children receiving their kits
- Children's reactions — smiles, excitement, pride in new school bags
- Group photo of all 20 beneficiary children with their kits
- Volunteer team photo

📁 **Photo archive location:** Project files are maintained in ADA's internal archive under reference ADA/2022/001. Photos are available for reporting and fundraising purposes, subject to child protection considerations.

Note: In accordance with child protection principles, photos of children are shared only in appropriate contexts, with consent, and without identifying information that could compromise their safety or dignity.

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9. Recommendations for Future Projects

Based on the findings and lessons from this project, the team recommends the following:

9.1 Immediate Follow-Up

1. **Return visit:** Schedule a follow-up visit to the school within 2 months to observe whether children are using their kits and to check on their well-being
2. **Expand to remaining children:** Plan a second distribution to reach additional orphaned children at the same school who were not included in this round
3. **School relationship maintenance:** Maintain regular contact with school administration to build the partnership for future interventions

9.2 Program Development

4. **Standardize the school-based model:** Document the event planning process as a replicable template for future school distributions at other schools
5. **Add educational materials:** Future kits should include notebooks, pencils, and other writing materials alongside household items
6. **Develop engagement curriculum:** Create a structured programme for the interactive sessions that can be adapted for different age groups and contexts
7. **Include guardian engagement:** Consider inviting caregivers/guardians to future events to build relationships and understand household needs

9.3 Organizational Growth

8. **Volunteer training programme:** Develop a brief orientation for new volunteers covering child protection, event coordination, and ADA's values
9. **Formal school partnerships:** Pursue written memoranda of understanding (MoUs) with partner schools for ongoing collaboration

10. **Donor engagement:** Use documentation from this event to develop fundraising materials and approach potential donors for larger-scale interventions
11. **Child protection policy:** Develop a formal child protection policy to guide all future interactions with minor beneficiaries
12. **Financial systems:** Continue strengthening financial tracking and receipt management as project budgets grow

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10. Financial Summary

Item	Budgeted (CFA)	Budgeted (USD)	Actual (CFA)	Actual (USD)	Variance (CFA)	N
Plastic buckets (20)	60,000	$100.00	54,000	$90.00	−6,000	Wh pric CFA
Plates, cups & utensils (20 sets)	100,000	$166.67	92,000	$153.33	−8,000	Bul disc fron ven
School bags (20)	80,000	$133.33	80,000	$133.33	0	Pur at b rate
Transport (vehicle hire)	25,000	$41.67	25,000	$41.67	0	Sin hire veh
Refreshments for children	15,000	$25.00	14,000	$23.33	−1,000	Drir bisc 20
Communication/coordination	5,000	$8.33	5,000	$8.33	0	Airt call coo
Documentation/printing	5,000	$8.33	4,000	$6.67	−1,000	Ben forn eve mat
Contingency	10,000	$16.67	6,000	$10.00	−4,000	Min unf exp
Total	**300,000**	**$500.00**	**280,000**	**$466.67**	**−20,000**	Unc bud

Unspent balance: 20,000 CFA ($33.33 USD) — returned to ADA general fund for future projects.

Funding source: Community donations and personal contributions from ADA members.

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11. Conclusion

The School Supply Distribution project represents a pivotal moment in ADA's organizational journey. In just three months since its founding intervention, ADA grew from 3 volunteers visiting individual widows to 8 volunteers executing a coordinated school-based event for 20 children. This growth — in team size, ambition, and operational complexity — demonstrates the organization's trajectory and the community's confidence in its mission.

But beyond the organizational milestones, this project was fundamentally about 20 children. Twenty orphaned boys and girls who walked into school that February morning without bags, without their own plates, without the basic items that signal to a child: someone cares about you. They walked out carrying colorful buckets and wearing pink school bags, having spent a morning being celebrated, encouraged, and reminded that they are not forgotten.

The image that stays with the team is not the logistics or the planning — it is the faces of children who had never owned a school bag putting one on for the first time. It is the quiet pride of a child carrying a bucket that is theirs. It is the laughter during the engagement session from children who, for one morning, were not defined by what they had lost but by what they were given.

ADA's mission is to empower vulnerable communities. On February 15, 2022, in a rural primary school in Buea, that mission took the form of 20 buckets, 20 bags, and 8 volunteers who showed up. It was enough. It is always enough to begin.

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12. Prepared By

ADA Project Team
Apoti Development Association
Buea, South-West Region, Cameroon

Report prepared: March 2022
Reference: ADA/2022/001

"Defend the weak and the fatherless; uphold the cause of the poor and the oppressed." — Psalm 82:3